

With this letter, I would like to express interest in the *MSc in Economics and Social Sciences* at the Università Commerciale Luigi Bocconi.

As a child, I could not understand my parent's decision to leave Sicily and move to Germany. Every summer, as I enjoyed my Grandma's cooking and Taormina's beaches, I would ask the same questions. *Why leave behind Mediterranean coastlines for the asphalt of suburban Frankfurt? And why leave your loved ones to venture into the unknown?*

It was not until I grew older that I found answers. While my Grandma's cooking remained delightful, my perception of Sicily changed, and I saw the grim economic realities that spurred millions of Sicilians to leave their motherland. This experience led me to recognize the tremendous power of economic incentives, sparking a desire to understand how these forces shape our lives and inciting me to pursue a BSc in economics.

Due to my multicultural upbringing, I have always been perceptive to developmental differences between countries. This interest deepened as I was introduced to economic growth models and I became fascinated by the macroeconomic processes that shape our world. Eager to learn more, I was drawn towards writers such as Jared Diamond, whose work *"Guns, Germs, and Steel"* proposes an agricultural narrative to explain the developmental trajectories of different societies. While Diamond views growth through an environmental lens, I recognized economic elements in his argument, and it led me to ponder the future of globalization—an area that I wish to explore deeper through electives such as *Globalization, Divergence and Inequality In Historical Perspective*.

My interest in economics solidified further as I witnessed the European debt crisis. Having family in Italy and Germany, I saw how its echoes rippled through the social fabric of both countries, stoking the fire of political agitators. These events inspired me to choose the elective *Money, Credit & Banking*, which familiarized me with the perils of financial markets. During a lecture, our professor recommended the online course *The Economics of Money & Banking* by the *Institute of New Economic Thinking*. I initially planned to watch only the components pertinent to my class, but my understanding of monetary theory was so fundamentally shaken that I completed it. Most notably, the course transformed my perception of money, introducing me to *chartalism* and *metallism* and illustrating how these two seemingly opposing theories can be useful in understanding money markets.

Apart from pure economics, I am also captivated by its interplay with politics. Perhaps the most fascinating course I have ever taken is *History of Economic Thought*, which taught me how economic theories are linked to socio-political circumstances. For instance, seeing how food shortages influenced Malthusian economics, or how Keynesianism was largely a response to the great depression, made me question how current events will shift our economic paradigms. Seeing this connection led me to pay closer attention to politics and inspired me to participate in the 2019 Model United Nations—a series of lively debates that honed my debate skills and strengthened my grasp of international relations.

Lastly, I strongly believe the future will bring complex economic challenges that require great flexibility and interdisciplinarity. My academic aim is to cultivate these traits and to become a multifaceted thinker and analytical problem-solver. In this regard, the *MSc in Economics and Social Sciences* with its broad choice of electives and strong quantitative focus appears to be an excellent choice. After my studies, I aspire to tackle high-stakes economic questions, either in academia or in policy analysis, and I am confident that a MSc from Bocconi—with its strong research component— will be the perfect stepping stone for a successful international career.

Thank you for considering my application, and I look forward to your response.

